



ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

emotionally ready, not when biology dictated. When I look at my three children today, I am deeply grateful to my younger self for choosing to keep that option alive.

However, it is important to stress that egg freezing does not guarantee a child. A woman still needs viable sperm. Embryos must form correctly, develop, implant and grow into a healthy pregnancy. Egg freezing should be seen as an insurance policy, not a promise. It widens possibility; it does not ensure an outcome.

Because egg freezing touches biology, identity, choice and deep emotion, women deserve balanced, stigma-free information. The procedure involves hormone stimulation, scans, injections and uncertainty about how many eggs will be retrieved or survive. It

demands emotional and physical commitment. Women need clarity, not fear, pressure or idealised promises.

Workplaces can play a supportive role, not by framing egg freezing to extend work years, but by recognising the emotional and medical complexity women may navigate.

Support includes more than financial coverage. It requires a culture where reproductive health can be discussed without stigma, where time for medical appointments is respected, and where overall wellbeing is valued. Fertility journeys also affect partners, and organisations should allow flexibility for men whose partners are undergoing treatment.

Social attitudes must evolve too. In smaller towns, discussions on fertility often collide with cultural expectations and limited access to women-centred care. Egg freezing is sometimes seen as defiance or indulgence. In reality, it is planning. It is responsibility. It is a woman choosing to keep a door open. No one should feel pressured to freeze their eggs, nor judged for considering it. True choice includes all possibilities: freezing, not freezing, and being unsure.

For India to progress meaningfully on women's health, fertility awareness must enter mainstream conversation. Many young women do not know how significantly fertility can decline with age.

Greater awareness, accessible medical guidance and conversations in regional languages can improve understanding and empower informed decisions.

Ultimately, egg freezing matters not because it promises certainty, but because it preserves possibility. For some women, it becomes a valuable safety net. For others, it may be unnecessary. Each choice is deeply personal and entirely valid.

For me, it provided time, clarity and peace of mind. It allowed me to shape motherhood on my own terms, rather than be confined by circumstances beyond my control. In a world full of unpredictability, creating options for oneself remains one of the quietest and most powerful acts of freedom. **BT**

Views are personal